

Desert records

Hot and cold deserts are full of extremes, so they hold quite a few impressive records.



Rainfall: a desert must have less than 2.5 cm (10 in) of rain per year.



Driest hot desert: is the Atacama Desert in South America.



Coldest desert: Antarctica is the coldest (and driest) desert.



Hottest desert: the Sahara Desert is the hottest in the world.



Biggest hot desert: the Sahara Desert covers one third of Africa.

Some cacti have spines instead of leaves, some have hairs. Spines protect the cactus from being eaten by animals.

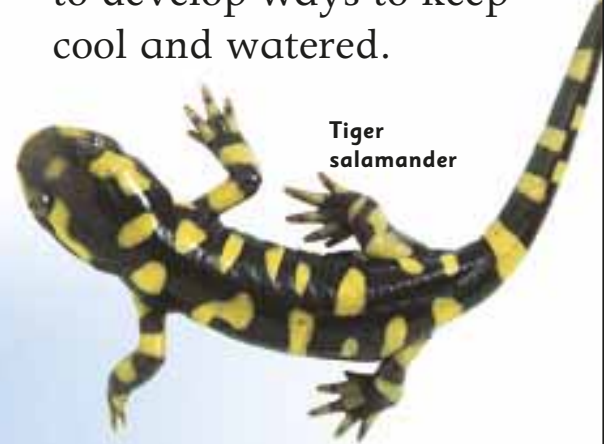
Cactus

Plant survivors

It is very difficult for plants to survive without much rainfall. The cactus is a clever plant because it collects water when it rains and stores it for dry periods.

Animal survivors

Desert animals have had to develop ways to keep cool and watered.



Tiger salamander

Night hunters

During the day, salamanders hide in deep underground burrows. They come out at night and feed on worms, insects, or other salamanders.

A camel's hump contains fat that can be broken down to release water.

Camel

Big thirst

A camel can survive for about three weeks without water. When it does drink, it can take in a huge amount.

to 20 m (63 ft) in the Sonoran Desert.

One Cardon cactus grew